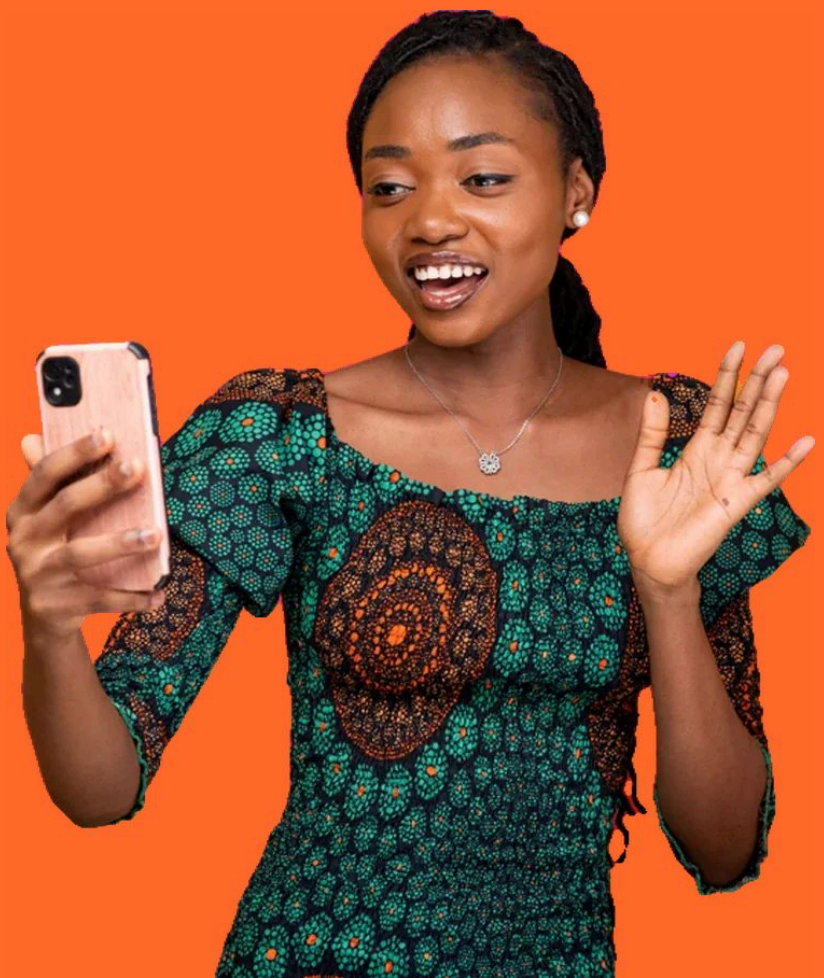
SHOPINBOS

FREE GUIDE · 2026 EDITION

The Online Seller's Starter Kit

Everything you need to start selling online in Nigeria, from your first product photo to your first ten orders. Six short chapters, with checklists and worksheets you can print and fill in.



8 pages · PDF

shopinbos.com

What's inside

7 short sections. Read it in order, or jump to the part you need today.

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Everything you need to start selling online in Nigeria, from your first product photo to your first ten orders. Six short chapters, with checklists and worksheets you can print and fill in.

You don't need a big budget, a laptop or a shop on the street. You need one good product, a phone, and a simple way for people to see it, order it and pay for it. This kit walks you through each step in plain words.

01 Start with what you have

Most successful online shops in Nigeria started small: one product, sold to people the owner already knew. Your contacts, your WhatsApp Status and your phone camera are enough to begin.

Pick one product to start with. Choose something you understand, that people around you already buy, and that you can get again easily. Good first products are things people buy often (snacks, skincare, everyday clothes) or things that make a good gift (bags, perfumes, gadgets).

You don't have to buy stock first. On Shopinbos you can add products from checked Nigerian suppliers in Find stock. When a customer buys, the supplier packs it with your shop's name and a rider delivers it. You keep the difference between your price and the supplier's price.

Worksheet: my first product

- What I will sell first: _____
- Who will buy it (age, city, what they care about): _____
- Where I will get it (my own, a supplier, Find stock): _____
- What it costs me: ₦_____
- What people usually pay for it: ₦_____

Checklist: before you start

- I have picked one product to start with
- I know what it costs me and what people pay for it
- I have at least 20 people in my contacts who might buy or share it
- I have a phone with a working camera and WhatsApp

02 Your first store in 5 minutes

A store link does what a price list photo can't: customers see every product, pick a size, add it to their bag and pay, any time of day, without waiting for you to reply.

How to set it up on Shopinbos:

1. Sign up with your phone number. We send a code on WhatsApp, so there is no password to remember.
2. Tell Rex, the store builder, what you sell. He picks a template, your colours and a name for your store with you.
3. Add your products. Take a photo, add a price and a short description. Or pick products from Find stock.
4. Share your link: yourname.shopinbos.com. It is free, and you can connect your own domain later.

Take product photos that sell:

- Use daylight from a window. Avoid the flash.
- Use a plain background: a white wall, a bedsheet or a sheet of cardboard.
- Show the product from the front, the side and up close, and one photo of it being used or worn.
- Keep your phone steady and fill the frame with the product.

Write descriptions people trust. Say what it is, the size or weight, what it is made of, and how long delivery takes. Short and clear beats long and clever.

Checklist: my store is ready

- My store name and logo are set
- At least five products have clear photos, prices and descriptions
- Delivery areas and prices are set
- I have opened my store link on my own phone and placed a test order

03 Get paid without wahala

Customers in Nigeria like to pay in different ways. A shop that accepts all of them sells more.

The ways your customers can pay on Shopinbos:

- **Card, bank transfer and USSD**, through Paystack. The fee is 1.5% + ₦100 per payment, capped at ₦2,000. The money lands in your Shopinbos balance straight away.
- **Pay on delivery**, for orders up to ₦50,000 in Lagos, Abuja, Ibadan and Port Harcourt. The customer pays the rider in cash or by transfer when the parcel arrives.

The 4-digit delivery code. Every pay on delivery order gets a code. The customer gives it to the rider only when they have the item in their hands. Never share the code yourself: if you do, the order can be marked delivered before the customer has it.

When you get your money. Riders pay in the cash they collect by 6pm the same day. Your balance is paid to your bank account every Friday, and you can withdraw early any time.

Stop the "I don't trust online shops" problem:

- Offer pay on delivery for first-time customers
- Show your phone number and WhatsApp on your store
- Share photos of real parcels you have sent (with the customer's permission)
- Reply to questions quickly and politely

Checklist: payments

- My bank account is added for payouts
- Pay on delivery is switched on, with a limit I am comfortable with
- I know my numbers: what I keep after the product cost, delivery and the payment fee

04 Deliver like a big brand

Delivery is where many online orders go wrong: riders who don't show up, parcels that arrive damaged, and customers who are "not around". A little planning fixes most of it.

Book riders from the order. On Shopinbos, customers see the delivery price for their area at checkout. When an order comes in, you book a rider with one tap, and you and your customer can follow the parcel.

Pack it well:

- Use a strong bag or box, and wrap fragile items twice
- Add a small thank-you card with your store link
- Take a photo of every parcel before it leaves. It takes five seconds and settles most arguments.

Plan for returns and refusals. Sometimes a customer refuses the parcel at the gate. The rider brings it back, and you pay only the return delivery fee. Write a simple returns rule (for example "exchanges within 3 days for the wrong size") and put it on your store.

Checklist: delivery

- My delivery areas and prices are set
- I have packing materials ready
- My returns rule is on my store
- I confirm each order on WhatsApp before booking the rider

05 Your first 10 orders

Your first ten orders will most likely come from people who already know you. That's normal, and it is how almost every shop starts.

Day 1: tell people. Post your store link on your WhatsApp Status with a photo of your best product and the price. Send a short personal message to 20 people who might buy or share.

Days 2 to 7: post every day. Show a different product each day. Share a short video, a customer's reaction, or how you pack orders. People buy from people they see often.

Use broadcasts, kindly. A WhatsApp broadcast reaches people who saved your number. Send one useful message a week, not five sales messages a day.

Follow up. If someone asked a question but didn't buy, send one friendly follow-up the next day. Peggy, the Shopinbos assistant, can answer common questions for you, in English or Pidgin.

Worksheet: my first 10 orders

- 20 people I will message today: _____
- My best product to post first: _____
- What I will post each day this week: _____
- My first order came from: _____

06 Grow with what works

Once orders are coming in, look at your numbers once a week. You don't need a spreadsheet full of formulas. Three numbers are enough.

The 3 numbers to watch every week:

1. **Orders:** how many orders you got this week, and where they came from (Status, Instagram, TikTok, your store).
2. **What you kept:** your sales minus product costs, delivery and payment fees. This is your real profit.
3. **Repeat customers:** how many people bought from you before. Repeat customers are the cheapest sales you will ever make.

Do more of what works. If most orders came from TikTok videos, make more videos. If one product sells out every week, order more of it or add similar products from Find stock.

When you are ready to spend on ads, start small: ₦2,000 to ₦5,000 a day on Instagram and Facebook, on a product that already sells well without ads. Stop ads that don't bring orders after three days.

Checklist: every Friday

- I checked my orders, what I kept and my repeat customers
- I wrote down what worked this week
- I picked one thing to try next week

07 What to do next

You now have everything you need to start: one product, a store link, payments that work, delivery you can trust, a plan for your first ten orders and three numbers to watch.

Start free on Shopinbos at shopinbos.com. Rex builds your store with you in about five minutes, and a real person is on WhatsApp if you get stuck.

SHOPINBOS

Ready to make your first sale?

Rex builds your store with you in 5 minutes. Take card, transfer and pay on delivery, book riders, and let Peggy answer customers on WhatsApp.

Start your shop free · shopinbos.com



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